The Heart of the Home Kit

Kitchens, Family Meals, Baking & Comfort Food

INSIDE THIS KIT

- Conversation Cards
- Word Link Game
- Musical Memory
- Trivia Time
- BINGO
- *Bonus:* Visual Spark Cards

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Why This Kit Works For You & Your Residents

Designed for real Activity Directors who need meaningful engagement without hours of prep.

Recognition Over Recall

Residents are not put on the spot to “remember.” Instead, familiar themes, visuals, and prompts gently spark recognition, allowing participation without pressure.

Dignified & Adult-Centric

Every activity is designed for adults — not childish or overly simplified. The tone, topics, and visuals respect life experience and identity.

Multi-Sensory Engagement

This kit blends conversation, visuals, music, and group interaction to engage different cognitive pathways. Residents can participate in the way that feels most natural to them.

Adaptable for All Abilities

Activities can be used 1:1, in small groups, or larger settings. You can scale up or down depending on cognitive level, energy, and time available.

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How to Run This Session

No prep. No guesswork. Just follow the flow.

YOUR DONE-FOR-YOU SESSION FLOW · 45–60 MINUTES

1

WARM UP

Conversation Cards

5–10 minutes

Gently open the session with familiar, low-pressure prompts. Encourages comfort, participation, and initial connection.

2

ENGAGE

Visual Spark Cards

10–15 minutes

Use imagery to trigger recognition, storytelling, and memory. Ideal for residents who respond better to visuals than direct questions.

3

CONNECT

BINGO or Trivia

15–20 minutes

Bring energy into the room with structured group interaction. Encourages laughter, participation, and shared experiences.

4

EMOTIONAL CLOSE

Musical Memory

10 minutes

End the session with music-based prompts or familiar songs. Creates emotional connection, calm, and a meaningful finish.

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What's Included in Your Kit

Everything you need to run multiple engaging sessions — without creating content from scratch.

6 ACTIVITIES · MULTIPLE SESSIONS · ZERO PREP

Conversation Cards
Thoughtfully written prompts that spark stories and memories. Works in group and one-on-one settings.

Visual Spark Cards
Image-based prompts that trigger recognition and emotional recall. Ideal for residents who respond better to visuals.

Trivia Game
Curated questions based on familiar themes and shared cultural experiences. Encourages participation, not frustration.

Word Link Game
Engaging word association activity that stimulates cognition in a low-pressure way. Works across all ability levels.

BINGO Activity
A familiar game adapted with meaningful, recognizable themes. Encourages group interaction and energy.

Musical Memory
Song and lyric-based activities that tap into emotional memory. Perfect for connection and ending on a high note.

TOTAL VALUE

Multiple activities. Multiple sessions. Use this kit again and again without repeating the same experience.

"Designed to save you hours of planning — while delivering meaningful, dignified engagement."

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SECTION 1

CONVERSATION CARDS

CONVERSATION STARTERS — CUT, LAMINATE & ENJOY

The Family Table

A-1

"What did your family's kitchen table look like? Was it big and crowded, or small and cozy? Who always sat in the same seat?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

A-2

"Was there a rule at your dinner table — elbows off, clean your plate, no singing? What happened if someone broke it?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

A-3

"Did your family say grace before meals, or was there another little ritual that signaled supper was starting?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Baking Day

B-1

"Was there a special day of the week set aside for baking in your house? What was the first thing you learned to bake, and who taught you?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

B-2

"Can you still smell it — the warm, sweet air when something was baking in the oven? What was the treat you could never wait for, even though it wasn't ready yet?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

B-3

"Did you ever have a baking disaster — something that burned, fell flat, or just didn't turn out right? What happened?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Secret Recipes & Sunday Suppers

C-1

"Was there a recipe in your family that was passed down — maybe written on a stained index card in someone's handwriting? What was it, and who was famous for making it?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

C-2

"What did Sunday supper look like at your house? Was it the biggest meal of the week, and did extra people show up for it?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

C-3

"Was there a dish that only one person in the family could make just right — and nobody else could ever quite match it?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

The Kitchen Itself

D-1

"Close your eyes and picture your childhood kitchen. What color were the walls? Was there a pattern on the floor? What sounds do you hear?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

D-2

"What appliance or gadget do you remember most fondly — the percolator, the hand mixer, the pressure cooker? Did it have a personality of its own?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

D-3

"Was the kitchen the gathering spot in your home? Did people sit and talk there even when no one was cooking?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Comfort Food & Guilty Pleasures

E-1

"What is the one meal that always made everything feel better — a bad day, a cold night, coming home after a long trip? What was it, and who made it for you?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

E-2

"Did you have a snack you weren't supposed to eat but always found a way to sneak? A spoonful of frosting, cookie dough, a slice of pie before dinner?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

E-3

"What food reminds you of a holiday — the turkey at Thanksgiving, fudge at Christmas, hot dogs on the Fourth of July? What made that food taste like celebration?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

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SECTION 2

VISUAL SPARK CARDS

IMAGE-BASED CONVERSATION STARTERS — CUT, LAMINATE & SHARE

SPARK 1

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 2

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 3

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 4

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 5

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

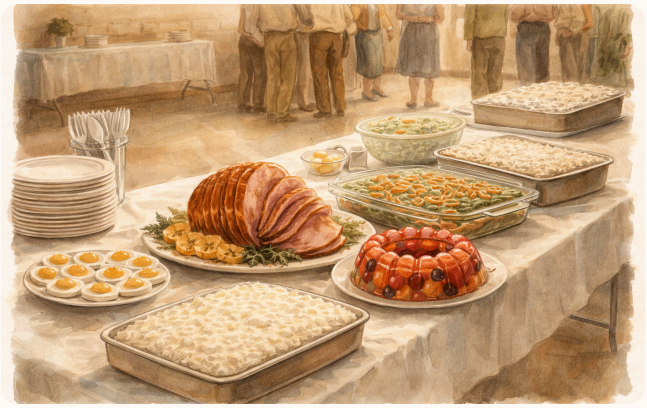
SPARK 6

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 7

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 8



✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 9

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 10

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

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SECTION 3

TRIVIA TIME

20 QUESTIONS — KITCHENS, COOKING & COMFORT FOOD

Kitchen Staples (Questions 1–5)

1. What brand of condensed soup became a pantry staple in almost every American kitchen — and later inspired a famous pop art painting?

Answer: Campbell's (Soup)

2. Before microwave ovens, what heavy, sealed pot was used to cook tough cuts of meat quickly using steam pressure?

Answer: Pressure cooker

3. What thick, white shortening, sold in a blue-labeled can, was a kitchen essential for making flaky pie crusts and biscuits?

Answer: Crisco

4. What appliance "percolated" on the counter every morning and filled the house with the aroma of fresh coffee?

Answer: A percolator (coffee percolator)

5. What powdered drink mix, originally created for astronauts, became a kitchen staple after it went to space in the 1960s?

Answer: Tang

Famous Foods & Brands (Questions 6–10)

6. What gelatin dessert, known for its bright colors and jiggly texture, was a staple at potlucks and church suppers for decades?

Answer: Jell-O

7. What iconic company put out a cookbook so widely used it was often called "the kitchen bible," with a red-and-white checkered cover?

Answer: Better Homes and Gardens (the "New Cook Book")

8. What canned meat product, made by Hormel, became a household name during wartime and a pantry fixture for decades after?

Answer: SPAM

9. What brand of frozen dinners, served in aluminum trays with compartments, helped popularize eating supper in front of the television?

Answer: Swanson (TV Dinners)

10. What bubbly drink, sometimes called "pop" and sometimes called "soda," came in glass bottles you returned to the store for a deposit?

Answer: Soda / Coca-Cola / soft drinks in returnable glass bottles

In the Kitchen (Questions 11–15)

11. What kitchen tool with two spinning beaters and a hand crank was used to whip cream, beat eggs, and mix batter before electric mixers?

Answer: A hand mixer / rotary egg beater

12. What roll of clingy, transparent material replaced wax paper for covering leftovers in the refrigerator?

Answer: Plastic wrap / Saran Wrap

13. What type of dishes, often sold at gas stations as a promotion, became a colorful staple in mid-century American kitchens?

Answer: Melmac (melamine dinnerware)

14. What heavy, black cooking pan — handed down through generations — was prized for frying chicken, baking cornbread, and searing steaks?

Answer: Cast-iron skillet

15. What small, rectangular appliance "popped up" sliced bread after toasting it golden brown?

Answer: A toaster

Meals & Traditions (Questions 16–20)

16. What creamy casserole, made with green beans and canned mushroom soup, became a Thanksgiving side-dish tradition?

Answer: Green bean casserole

17. On a hot summer day, what hand-cranked machine did families use on the back porch to make frozen dessert from cream, sugar, and ice?

Answer: An ice cream maker / hand-crank ice cream freezer

18. What hearty, layered Italian-American dish, made with wide flat noodles, ricotta, and tomato sauce, was a staple at family gatherings?

Answer: Lasagna

19. What breakfast staple was delivered to the front doorstep in glass bottles by a uniformed delivery man each morning?

Answer: Milk (from the milkman)

20. What sticky, golden syrup — often stored in a bear-shaped bottle — was drizzled on biscuits, stirred into tea, and used in home remedies?

Answer: Honey

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SECTION 4

WORD LINK GAME

FIND THE BRIDGE WORD

Read the two outside words aloud. Residents find the single "bridge word" that fits in the blank to complete a familiar compound word or phrase on BOTH sides.

#	LEFT WORD	BRIDGE WORD	RIGHT WORD
1	CUP	_____	WALK
2	APPLE	_____	BOAT
3	CORN	_____	BOX
4	SUGAR	_____	RACK
5	EGG	_____	FISH
6	COOK	_____	WORM
7	BUTTER	_____	SHAKE
8	POT	_____	LESS
9	DISH	_____	FALL
10	PEPPER	_____	FIELD
11	PAN	_____	BAR
12	MEAT	_____	PARK
13	TABLE	_____	FEED
14	FIRE	_____	WORK

#	LEFT WORD	BRIDGE WORD	RIGHT WORD
15	**HONEY**	_____	**OVER**

Answer Key

1. CAKE	2. SAUCE	3. BREAD
4. COAT	5. SHELL	6. BOOK
7. MILK	8. LUCK	9. WATER
10. CORN	11. HANDLE	12. BALL
13. SPOON	14. HOUSE	15. COMB

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The Heart of the Home Kit BINGO

Mark each square as it's called · Five in a row wins!

B	I	N	G	O
Sunday Roast	Cast-Iron Skillet	Meatloaf	Rolling Pin	Kitchen Timer
Deviled Eggs	Checkered Tablecloth	Percolator	Cooling Rack	Mason Jar
Mixing Bowl	Apron	FREE SPACE	Jell-O Mold	Wooden Spoon
Pressure Cooker	Potluck Supper	Casserole Dish	Recipe Box	Ice Cream Maker
Cookie Jar	Bread Basket	Gravy Boat	Pie Crust	Oven Mitts

Print one copy per resident · Use coins, buttons, or markers to cover squares

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BINGO Facilitation Guide

BONUS ENGAGEMENT PROMPTS · FOR THE FACILITATOR ONLY

When someone calls “Cast-Iron Skillet”

A good cast-iron skillet was handed down like a family treasure. Did anyone in your family have one that had been seasoned for years? What was the best thing ever cooked in it?

When someone calls “Cookie Jar”

Every kitchen had one. What shape was your family's cookie jar, and what was usually inside it? Did anyone get caught sneaking from it?

When someone calls “Recipe Box”

Those little boxes held a lifetime of cooking. Did your family have one with handwritten cards? Is there a recipe in there you wish you still had?

When someone calls “Meatloaf”

Meatloaf night was a staple in so many homes. How did your family make theirs — with ketchup on top, onion soup mix, or a secret ingredient? What did you eat alongside it?

When someone calls “Potluck Supper”

Church basements, neighborhood gatherings, family reunions — who brought the best dish to the potluck, and was there ever a dish everyone avoided?

When someone calls “Sunday Roast”

The smell of a roast cooking all afternoon could fill an entire house. What cut of meat did your family use, and was there a fight over who got the crispy bits?

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SECTION 6

MUSICAL MEMORY

Part A: Finish the Lyric

Read the artist name and the beginning of the lyric. Residents complete the missing word or phrase.

The Archies (1969)

Sugar, Sugar

"Sugar... ah, honey, ___"

Answer: Honey

Shirley Temple (1934)

On the Good Ship Lollipop

"On the good ship Lollipop, it's a sweet trip to a candy ___ where bon-bons play"

Answer: Shop

Dean Martin (1953)

That's Amore

"When the moon hits your eye like a big pizza ___"

Answer: Pie

Doris Day (1950)

Tea for Two

"Tea for two and two for ___"

Answer: Tea

Fats Domino (1956)

Blueberry Hill

"I found my thrill on Blueberry ___"

Answer: Hill

Traditional Folk Song (Traditional)

Shortnin' Bread

“Mama's little baby loves shortnin', shortnin', Mama's little baby loves shortnin' ___ ”

Answer: Bread

Part B: Name That Kitchen Tune

Read the clue. Residents name the song.

B-1

"Hank Williams sang about a Cajun feast simmering in a big pot — crawfish pie, filé gumbo — and a good time down on the bayou. Name that spicy tune."

Answer: "Jambalaya (On the Bayou)" (Hank Williams, 1952)

B-2

"Little Richard hollered and hammered the piano on this 1955 rock and roll classic. The title sounds like a frozen Italian treat, and it starts with "A-wop-bop-a-loo-bop!""

Answer: "Tutti Frutti" (Little Richard, 1955)

B-3

"In a beloved 1964 movie musical, a practically perfect nanny sings that just a spoonful of something sweet helps the medicine go down. What's the song?"

Answer: "A Spoonful of Sugar" (Julie Andrews, from Mary Poppins, 1964)

B-4

"Jimmy Buffett sang about wasting away while searching for a lost shaker of salt in this 1977 beach anthem named after a famous tequila cocktail."

Answer: "Margaritaville" (Jimmy Buffett, 1977)

B-5

"The Andrews Sisters had a huge hit with this calypso-flavored novelty song about a popular drink that mixes a Caribbean spirit with America's favorite cola."

Answer: "Rum and Coca-Cola" (The Andrews Sisters, 1945)

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